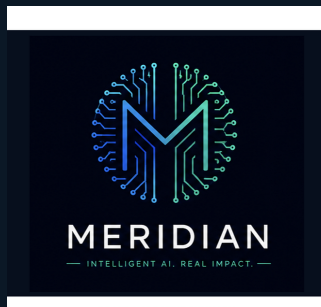




Stargas Supplies

Opportunities and Grant Aid Intelligence

Gas cylinder testing, market expansion and grant-funded growth

Prepared for Anthony Hennessy

PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

THE OPPORTUNITY

Stargas is an independent Irish challenger against two multinational-owned majors, on a rent-free cylinder model with 60+ stockists nationwide. Your ambition to build **the best gas cylinder testing location with the best equipment in Ireland** lands on a genuinely thin field — independent research found at most one or two named independent cylinder test houses in the country, one of which markets itself as “Ireland’s only independent cylinder testing facility.” That is a real gap worth testing directly.

FIVE OPPORTUNITIES

- 1. Best-in-Ireland cylinder testing.** The competitive field is thin. The open question worth settling first: where do Irish LPG cylinders currently go for testing, and is that gap real, or already closed off by the majors internally.
- 2. Contract testing for other distributors.** The genuine new revenue line on top of Opportunity 1 — test other companies’ cylinders, not just your own fleet. Turns a compliance cost centre into a second business.
- 3. BioLPG as a supply-side addition.** Both Calor and Flogas already sell renewable, drop-in-compatible LPG — no new infrastructure required, and it reinforces cylinder-testing demand on the existing fleet rather than threatening it.
- 4. Northern Ireland stockist expansion.** Realistic via the Windsor Framework green lane (UKIMS), pending direct confirmation of how filled cylinders specifically are treated crossing the border.
- 5. Grant-funded testing facility upgrade.** Real, named Irish and UK schemes exist and fit a company of Stargas’s profile — see below.

GRANT AID INTELLIGENCE

LEO Business Expansion Grant -- the near-term route

For established businesses (Stargas, trading since 2010, qualifies easily) that are micro-enterprises. Funds new equipment purchase at up to 50% of investment, capped at €80,000 (up to €150,000 in some cases). The single most directly relevant scheme for cylinder-testing equipment specifically.

Enterprise Ireland -- Capital Investment for Decarbonisation

Up to €1m for carbon-reducing capital equipment. A credible next-stage route if the testing facility investment is framed around energy-efficient compressors, heat recovery, or BioLPG-handling infrastructure.

SEAI EXEED Grant Scheme

Up to €3m per project for decarbonisation/energy-efficiency capital investment — the larger-scale option if the testing facility is bundled with wider site energy upgrades.

Invest NI Business Innovation Grant -- if NI expansion is pursued

£5,000–£20,000 at 70% support for market research and market entry — a natural fit for a first NI feasibility study.

Recommended path: LEO Business Expansion Grant first, as the concrete near-term route; EI/SEAI as the credible next stage if the investment scales up. All figures independently sourced; none invented.

Overall Read

The evidence supports treating “best cylinder testing location in Ireland” as a genuinely live opportunity, not a stretch ambition — the competitive field is thin, the regulatory anchor (EN 1440, TPED) is clear, and real grant support exists to fund it. The one fact worth settling before any capital is committed: where Irish LPG cylinders currently go for testing today.